Mention needs to be made of the Parali brothers: Shanmugasundaram Pillai, Nellaiyappa Pillai and Kuzhandaivelan Pillai hailing from Paralikottai village near Tirunelveli. Interestingly, it was the youngest, Kuzhandaivelan Pillai (?1890–1936) who led the brothers to VOC. Apart from a cryptic reference that he was practically a member of the family and was instrumental in leading his brothers to VOC, we know little of how the relationship was established. The eldest of the brothers, Shanmugasundaram Pillai figures in many of the government documents. Beginning as VOC's vakil gomasta (he may have been barely twenty years old at that time), he became an employee of SSNCo primarily to canvass shares. Based in Sirkazhi, he succeeded in selling many shares in Thanjavur district.[3] Later, some of the notices for Swadeshi meetings were issued in his name. He was also the designated editor of the aborted *Swarajya* that was to appear on 9 March 1908 on the occasion of the celebration of Bipin Chandra Pal's release from prison. It was Shanmugasundaram who filed the affidavit on behalf of VOC in the security proceedings in March 1908. After VOC's arrest he 'assisted [VOC] in court through-out the case'—in the words of the convicting judge.[4] In his autobiography, VOC refers to him fondly. Unfortunately, Shanmugasundaram vanishes after the heady days of the Swadeshi movement. However, Nellaiyappa Pillai (Figure 6) hovers over the life of not only VOC but also Subramania Bharati. Barely seventeen years old when he joined VOC, Nellaiyappa Pillai not only did clerical work in SSNCo but also assisted in VOC's political work. As a trusted assistant, he too was arrested with VOC and lodged in Palayamkottai prison as an undertrial. When VOC was convicted and imprisoned in Coimbatore Central Jail, Nellaiyappa Pillai spent a year in its vicinity, acting as his emissary to the outside world and assisting him and his family in various ways. Thanks to his prodding, VOC wrote the first part of his verse autobiography—a pre-eminent source for writing his life. Maintaining a close association with VOC and his family until the last, he also penned his biography in 1944. Throughout his long life as a journalist and public figure, he kept the memory of VOC (and Subramania Bharati) alive, for which he was even teased by contemporaries.